

The philosopher as a practical person. We tend to think of philosophers as people who dwell in ivory towers of thought and come up with books that take a lot of learning before you can understand them. There is considerable truth in this picture. Philosophy has come so far since the ancient Greeks first mused upon the world and man that, these days, the philosophers seem to be talking to the philosophers and we ordinary folk are out in the cold.

Consider, however, that the basic purpose of philosophy is to search out the *why* of things. That is why the Science of Personal Achievement is a philosophy rather than a *method* or a *system*. In my previous books, as in this one, I give the truly basic answers to the questions:

Why do some men succeed in life while others fail?

Why do some individuals and couples live in harmony while others live in constant conflict?

Why do some groups get along with other groups in a spirit of mutual help, while others hamper and frustrate each other?

While the *methods* by which you make money, or handle your affairs, or please your wife, or preserve harmony between management and labor are important—and I show you a number of the key methods—it is the *underlying philosophy* which is more important still. When your mind holds firmly to the basic concepts of wealth, peace of mind and life-success, you build on a firm foundation. When you try to apply methods merely in themselves, you may find you are trying to build on sand.

Thus it pays to be a philosopher in a perfectly practical sense. Faced with a problem, or desirous of improving some situation or influencing some other person for your mutual benefit—pause and remember you are a practical philosopher. Thus you focus your mind upon the basic reasons which always have worked and always will, and immediately you are well guided.

The philosopher in action. Does the philosopher meet with some disaster or misfortune? He looks for the cause, he seeks the lesson, he armors himself against the event ever happening again.

Likewise he notices the mistakes other people make. Knowing that human beings are very like one another, he